JAMES MATTHEW RICHARDSON

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Bristol, United Kingdom

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 10 years of experience building scalable systems and leading technical initiatives. I started my career fixing database issues at a startup in Nottingham, and somehow ended up here managing architectural decisions for distributed platforms. I'm most comfortable when I'm deep in performance optimization work or reviewing architectural designs. I enjoy mentoring junior engineers and figuring out how to make complex infrastructure problems actually manageable. I've always been drawn to backend systems and infrastructure challenges more than frontend work.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Graduate Software Engineer

TechCore Solutions Ltd

Nottingham, United Kingdom

June 2014 - August 2015

Developed and maintained REST APIs for internal customer management systems using Node.js and Express framework

Directed a department of 52 engineers across four teams, overseeing product roadmap and quarterly planning cycles

Implemented automated testing suite that increased code coverage from 35% to 78% across the codebase

Led migration of legacy monolithic application to microservices architecture serving 2 million daily active users

Senior Systems Architect

CloudBridge Technologies

www.cloudbridgetech.io

London, United Kingdom

September 2015 - February 2017

Architected and deployed Kubernetes infrastructure supporting 40+ microservices across multiple cloud providers

Designed event-driven architecture using Apache Kafka processing 500,000 messages per second in production

Established infrastructure-as-code practices using Terraform, reducing infrastructure provisioning time by 85%

Mentored team of 8 junior and mid-level engineers on cloud-native best practices and system design patterns

Staff Engineer

DataFlow Systems

www.dataflowsystems.co

Bristol, United Kingdom

March 2017 - Present

Designed and implemented distributed data pipeline infrastructure handling petabyte-scale analytics workloads daily

Established engineering standards and best practices for the entire 120-person engineering organization

Led cross-functional initiative to reduce API latency by 62% through caching strategies and database optimization

Owned technical roadmap for core platform services, balancing feature requests with infrastructure investments

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2014

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Go, JavaScript, Java, SQL, Bash

Platforms and Tools: Kubernetes, Docker, AWS, GCP, Terraform, Apache Kafka, PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, Git

Architecture and Patterns: Microservices, Event-Driven Architecture, CQRS, Domain-Driven Design, Distributed Systems

Specializations: Infrastructure-as-Code, Performance Optimization, System Design, CI/CD Pipeline Design, Database Optimization